

Cuts and Lacerations - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1080 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Cut/laceration wound assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Clinical background

- Most small cuts can be managed by controlling bleeding, cleaning the wound, and applying a clean dressing.
- Uncontrolled or spurting bleeding, loss of sensation or movement, a very large or deep wound, or an embedded object requires emergency assessment.
- Increasing redness, swelling, pain, pus, fever, or retained contamination can indicate infection or need for professional wound care.

Pain severity

- Mild (1-3): Does not interfere with normal activity, movement, or sleep.
- Moderate (4-7): Interferes with normal activity, movement, or sleep.
- Severe (8-10): Prevents normal activity or movement, or is described as excruciating.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, anticoagulated, immunocompromised, or diabetic, where is the wound, and exactly how did it occur? Include bite, puncture, contamination, body-fluid exposure, and child/vulnerable-person safeguarding concerns.
2. [OPEN_TEXT] How did the cut happen, and roughly how big/deep is it?
3. [YES_NO] Is the bleeding under control with direct pressure?
4. [PAIN_SEVERITY] What is the pain severity from 0 to 10, and how is it affecting movement, activity, or sleep?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Animal Bite

Was this wound caused by an animal or human bite?

Bites have distinct infection, tetanus, blood-borne-virus, and rabies considerations and require the bite pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is bleeding uncontrolled or spurting bright red blood, is there numbness or trouble moving near the wound, is it a bad cut on the face or palm, is the wound very large or deep, or is something stuck in it (e.g. glass)?

NHS.UK cuts and grazes guidance lists these as emergency ambulance or Emergency Department criteria.

1. Disposition level 70

Does the wound have soil, pus, or dirt still in it after cleaning, was it from a person or animal bite, is it swollen/red/getting more painful or leaking pus, is it larger than about 5cm, or does the caller feel generally unwell or feverish?

NHS.UK guidance lists these as reasons to seek urgent clinical review or arrange a primary-care review for the wound.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a small, shallow cut with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes minor cuts as manageable at home with basic first aid.

Advice

Qatar emergency wound response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Apply continuous firm direct pressure with a clean dressing, adding layers without removing soaked ones. Do not remove or press directly on an embedded object. Keep the person still and warm. If a body part is amputated, wrap it in clean damp material, seal it in a bag, and keep the bag cool without direct ice contact. Follow 999 instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: bleeding will not stop or is spurting; pale, cold, faint, confused, or unresponsive person; loss of movement, feeling, or circulation.

Urgent wound review

- Clean the wound as best as possible and arrange same-day medical review for cleaning, possible antibiotics, or stitches.
- Call Back If: increasing redness, swelling, or pus; fever develops.

Home first aid for a minor cut

- Wash hands, check for anything embedded, apply pressure with a clean cloth, raise the area above the heart if bleeding, rinse once bleeding stops, pat dry, and cover with a sterile dressing or plaster. Keep clean and dry and change as needed.
- Call Back If: signs of infection develop; wound does not heal as expected.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Apply continuous firm direct pressure with a clean dressing, adding layers without removing soaked ones. Do not remove or press directly on an embedded object. Keep the person still and warm. If a body part is amputated, wrap it in clean damp material, seal it in a bag, and keep the bag cool without direct ice contact. Follow 999 instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Cuts and grazes", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/cuts-and-grazes/> (page last reviewed 02 April 2026)

Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from the cited NHS.UK pages under the Open Government Licence v3.0; it is not licensed STCC content.

Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect and is not a disposition row. Local disposition mappings and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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